Indian counter-insurgency response, Lashkar faced the same hurdles as all of the other Pakistani groups. These included hostility to foreign fighters because of their pro-accession positions, their extremist views regarding Islam and resentment stemming from their poor treatment of the local populace. Foreign militants often arrived unannounced at people's homes and demanded shelter, extorted money and manpower for the insurgency, and made a practice of violently taking over mosques to preach their ideology.

Lashkar did not get off to a great start when it came to living up to is name as the 'Army of the Pure,' and was as guilty of these offenses as HuA and other 'guest mujahideen.' However, Lashkar was more capable—or perhaps more willing—to learn as an organization in terms of how its cadres engaged with the local populace. It is also possible that its sponsors in the army and ISI leaned on the group to do so. According to Lt. General Vinayak Patankar (Retd), who held a command post in the conflict zone, the Indian army intercepted communications telling Lashkar militants to pay for food, avoid theft or extortion and not to fraternize with local women.[48] One member of the group confirmed that such instructions were issued. He and several other interlocutors said that cadres began paying money to stay in people's homes, as well as bringing their own food and water in order not to impose.[49] The order to avoid fraternization with local women also made a difference, as there was a high prevalence of rape during the course of the Kashmiri conflict, committed by militants and Indian security forces.[50] In this environment, 'a group that does not touch your women was bound to gain some appreciation,' to quote one Indian expert who spent nearly a decade conducting field research on the conflict.[51] This does not mean Lashkar was entirely pure. Some of its members were implicated in mistreating Barelvi woman in Indian-administered Kashmir, including periodic rape. Nor did Lashkar's cadres entirely refrain from extortion. On the whole, however, its cadres were less involved in these types of negative incidents than those from other groups. According to one Kashmiri journalist who covered the conflict from its inception, Lashkar also sometimes intervened to stop other militants from disturbing the citizenry or to settle disputes, which were adjudicated based on sharia.[52]